I went home full of eagerness and started "Little Lost Robot" a third time, on September 10. It was about a robot which, interpreting an order too literally, lost itself in a crowd of similar robots and had to be identified quickly or great danger would ensue.

This time I had no trouble and, working steadily, I finished it in five days, even though it was ten thousand words long and the longest of the robot stories to date. On September 16, I took it in to Campbell at 11:30 a.m., and at 2:30 p.m. I called him and found it was an acceptance at $.02 a word. On September 28, I received my check for $200. It was my first post-Army sale.

Something else followed almost at once. On September 14, I had received a telegram from a lawyer who said that his client (whom he did not identify) wanted to buy all rights to "Evidence." I went to see the lawyer on my way to Campbell on the sixteenth, and all I could get out of him was that his client wanted movie rights in particular and would pay $250 for it.

Campbell told me he thought $250 was fair for movie rights to a short story, but Gertrude suggested I ask $1,000. (Gertrude was nearer right, but neither she nor Campbell understood the situation any more than I did. I ought to have granted movie rights for a specific period, said rights to be renewed for more money at the end of the period. Selling all rights permanently for any sum was terrible and I was being cheated, but of course I didn't know that.)

I called the lawyer and asked for $1,000 and that I wouldn't discuss the matter any further unless I knew who his client was.

On September 20, the lawyer called again and said he was representing Orson Welles. I jumped for joy and let him have the movie rights for $250. Welles was a favorite of mine, both for his movies and, in those days, for a newspaper column he was writing.

I got Astounding to grant me the necessary rights on September 27, took them around to the lawyer, and collected my $250. I felt great,

but the whole transaction was barren. The picture was never made, and from that day to this, Welles owns the movie, radio, and television rights to that story and I cannot sell it elsewhere. What a fool I was!

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Professor Boyd of Boston University School of Medicine was in New York on September 18, at the home of a friend of his—Arthur Sard, a mathematics